

GOLD

University

UNLOCK THE KEY

TO SELLING GOLD THROUGH FEATURES,
BENEFITS & CHECK QUESTIONS

Gold Jewelry:

Setting the
gold standard for
Piercing Pagoda Stores

WHAT YOU WILL LEARN

The different characteristics about gold and why it is
important to you and Piercing Pagoda

Information about metals with a focus on Gold

Tie features into benefits to create an exceptional
Customer experience

Product knowledge that makes us better informed,
more confident in selling, and a valued resource to
the Customer

WHY IS GOLD IMPORTANT TO YOU AND PAGODA?

Why is gold product important to you and Piercing Pagoda? Carrying gold in our stores:

- Fulfills Signet's mission of Celebrating Life/Expressing Love.
- Supports Vision 2020 of growing in the mid-market.
- Builds on our heritage of gold with a broad selection of Earrings, Chain, Charms and fashion collections.
- Sets the standard of the Store.
- Increases your earning potential.
- Increases your average ticket.



Gold
business is over
half of total
Pagoda sales.

US demand for gold rose in 2013 for the first time since 2001, and this trend continues.

AN INTRODUCTION TO METAL JEWELRY

PRECIOUS METALS

- We carry 2 precious metals: **Gold** and **Silver**
- Ideal for use in jewelry because of their allure, rarity, workability, and durability.
- Highly valued because they are difficult to extract from the earth.

Base Metals

Alternative Metals

- Also referred to as non-precious metals such as brass, bronze, copper, zinc, tin and nickel.
- More abundant
- More easily extracted from the earth, and therefore less expensive.

- We carry stainless steel and titanium - these metals are man made.
- Used for bolder and contemporary design.

TERMS YOU NEED TO KNOW

- Luster - the appearance of a jewelry in reflected light. Determined largely on how well it is polished.
- Workability - Can be fashioned into almost any shape and it will retain that shape.
- Durability - Strong and long-wearing, resistant to impact and corrosion.
- Alloy - A mixture of 2 or more metals.
- Gram Weight - Jewelry is weighed in gram weight (metric system).
- Penny Weight - The English equivalent of the gram weight metric system.
- Gauge - A unit of measure that refers to the thickness of the jewelry.

Finishes give each piece of jewelry a distinctive look. The finishes listed below are some of the most commonly used in our assortment.

High polish

- Gives the metal a highly reflective, shiny look.



Satin - Created by brushing the metal. The result is a soft, pearl-like luster on the metal space.



Diamond cut - Diamond tipped precision cutting tools are used to create a pattern of fine sharp flat cuts.

Hammered - Texture applied to the surface of a metal piece with a hammer to give it a dimpled look.

GOLD A SIGN OF DISTINCTION

For centuries, gold has been a global status symbol and in today's economy, gold remains a strong player. As part of the largest specialty jeweler in the US, Canada, and the UK, which allows us to offer quality jewelry at an exceptional value.

Piercing Pagoda is the affordable fine jeweler.

- Everlasting and commemorative.
- Signifies power and respect.
- Measured in karats.
- Purest form is 24K and is naturally yellow.
- Virtually indestructible.
- The quality of our gold merchandise is the same quality you will find in all fine jewelers.

THE COLOR OF GOLD

How does gold get its color?

Gold is combined with specific metal combinations to obtain a certain color characteristic.

Yellow gold is combined with copper & zinc or copper & silver for durability.

White gold is combined with nickel, zinc, copper, & manganese.



Pink or "Rose" gold is combined with copper.

Other color combinations include:



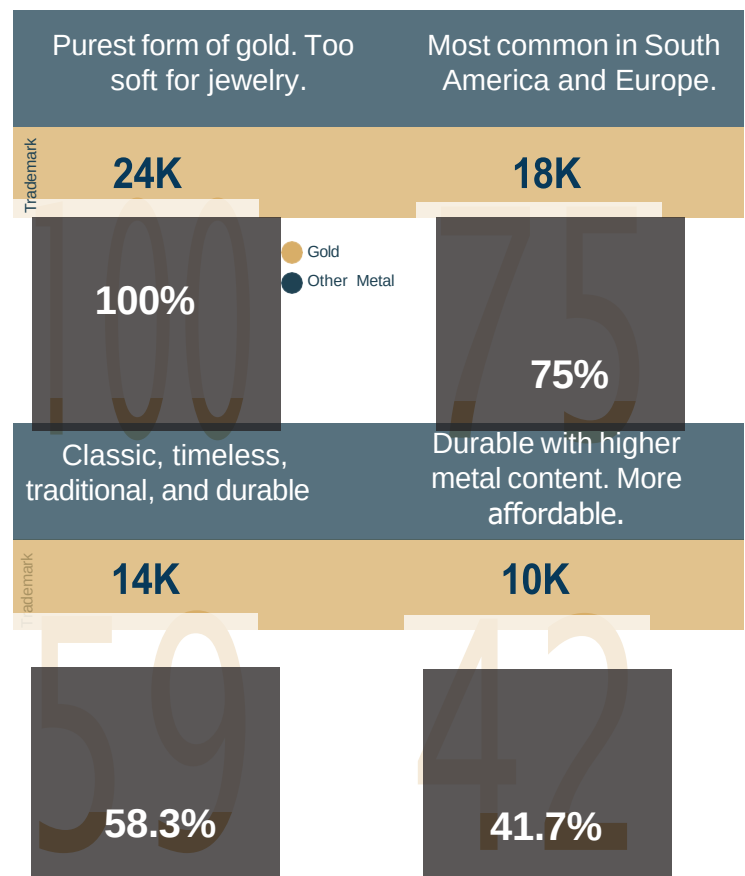
Two tone - Yellow & White Gold

Tri color - Yellow, White, Pink Gold

Bi color - Pink & Yellow gold

Weights & Measures

A stamp of 24K, 18K, 14K, and 10K has special meaning, it indicates if the gold is 100% pure or a blend. The chart below describes each. Our gold is always stamped with a trademark and verification of authenticity and can be located on the jewelry item, including a jump ring or an earring post. Jewelry items also include a manufacturer's trademark or Pagoda (PGDA).



DO YOU KNOW WHAT AFFECTS THE PRICING ON GOLD JEWELRY?

There are a number of components that have an effect on how gold is priced. It's not based solely on the price of gold. Here are a few of those factors:

- The cost of precious metals fluctuates daily.
- Add the cost of craftsmanship and design.
- Add the cost of manufacturing.
- Add the cost of shipping and handling.
- We buy direct from manufacturers and pass those savings onto our Customers.

FEATURES of Gold

BEST

BETTER

14K Gold

- Highest karat count we carry at Piercing Pagoda and very durable
- These are your classic, timeless pieces
- Our assortment in 14K includes chain, earrings, childrens, charm, piercing earrings, and body jewelry

10K Gold

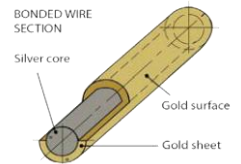
- This is the affordable and durable option for karat gold
- These are your classic, on-trend, fashion forward pieces
- Our assortment in 10K includes chain, earrings, bridal, diamond, childrens, charms, piercing earrings, and body jewelry



Bonded

2 precious metals
2gether **4**ever.

The bonded wire contains a fine sterling silver core wrapped in gold. 1/20th of total weight must be gold.



Gold Filled

Gold filled metal jewelry follows a similar process to bonded metals with the difference being 1 base metal wrapped in gold. 1/20th of the total weight of the product must be gold and with reasonable care, both gold bonded and gold filled jewelry will last a lifetime.

GOOD

Plated Jewelry

In our GOOD category, we have plated jewelry. This process places a thin layer of gold or silver on any metal (sterling silver, bronze or brass) and carries a trademark of (GP) for gold plated or (SP) for silver plated. Customers get the look of gold, at a fraction of the price.

Sterling Silver

- Silver in its purest form is .999. It is too soft to make jewelry so when combined with copper, it forms the alloy sterling silver. The trademark becomes .925 and due to the copper, silver can darken over time
- A very affordable, precious metal
- All of our sterling silver chains are Italian-made using a patented tarnish resistant alloy and finish
- All of our other jewelry is treated to slow tarnishing

Stainless Steel

- An alternative metal that we use primarily in men's at Piercing Pagoda
- It is highly durable, scratch resistant and resistant to corrosion
- Hypoallergenic
- Very affordable
- Because of strength used for bolder looks

Titanium

- An alternative metal
- At Piercing Pagoda you would find this in our piercing earrings
- Lightweight, very strong
- Hypoallergenic

TRADEMARKS

A trademark can be a word, name, symbol, design, or any combination of this list. It is used in commerce to identify and distinguish the goods of manufacturers and indicates the source of the goods. Per federal regulations, all jewelry sold in the US must be stamped with metal content abbreviations.

Those abbreviations can be found on our chains or bracelets close to the clasp, on earring posts or the back of the earring, the inside of a hoop, on pendants/charms on the back of the bale, and on rings inside the shank of the ring. The abbreviations are:

14K/14KT - 14 karat gold	:	BRS - Brass	:	TTN - Titanium	:	SSTL/SST - Stainless Steel
10K/10KT - 10 karat gold	:	BNZ - Bronze	:	.925 - Sterling Silver	:	

CHAINS

Did **?**
you
know

These **6** chains
do **85%** of our
total chain
sales!

Features & Benefits

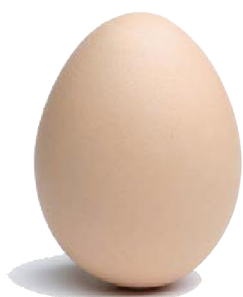
At Piercing Pagoda we offer top quality chain at an affordable price because we buy direct from the manufacturer.

We provide the largest chain selection in the mall and styles include fashion to basic chains, pendant chains to heavier link chains in multiple finishes from high polish, diamond-cut and reversible styles; our Customer gets two looks for the price of one.

Our quality assurance (QA) department inspects and weighs our chains for gold content and trademark to meet our standards. Additionally, upon request, they perform a 7 pound pull test; all chain is designed to be durable. Other advancements include a quality clasp to make it easier to fasten your chain.

Most of our chain is made in Italy. Many people associate Italy with brands such as Ferrari, Armani, and many other brands with a history of high quality and cutting edge design. Italy is the birthplace of jewelry manufacturing and has a rich history of high quality and exquisite design. All of our sterling silver chain is made in Italy.

One myth we need to debunk is that magnetic testing is an accurate way to test an item for gold content. It is not a true indicator. 24K gold is not magnetic and 14K and 10K are mixed with alloys that may attach to a magnet but gold is not magnetic. Myth #2 is that hollow gold is not as durable as solid. The truth is that it is just as durable as solid. Think of it this way: what's the difference between an uncooked egg and a boiled egg? We all think the boiled egg is stronger because it feels solid but in reality it is the exact same shell that protects both eggs. Each chain is made using a special wire unique to both and since wire thickness on the chain are exactly the same, they both have the same amount of surface to be soldered.



Every store has each of
the 6 chains above.

Chain Varieties & Length/Inches

Children's Chain	13", 15"
Pendant Chain	16", 18", 20"
Men's Chain	20", 22", 24", 26"
Longer Lengths	30", 36"

Children's Bracelet	5"-6"
Women's Bracelet	7"-8"
Men's Bracelet	8"-9"
Anklet	9"-11"

EARRINGS

Features & Benefits



CZ Stud

Like gold chain, early evidence of earring jewelry dates back centuries and can be made of various metals. Our Customers wear earrings for many different reasons, whether its cultural or fashion. In each instance, they are looking to make a statement. Earrings are the #1 sales category at Piercing Pagoda and these four styles represent 97% of the total earring sales at Piercing Pagoda.



Hoops

All posts are solid double notched posts to prevent loss. The QA department plays a critical role in inspecting and weighing our earrings to ensure each one meets quality standards. Most gold and silver earrings have a hypoallergenic silicone encased butterfly clutch. This feature helps the earring back retain its strength and makes it easier to find if it is accidentally dropped. All silver earrings are nickel free, minimizing allergic reaction.

After our posts earrings, hoops is our next largest category, we offer a variety of finishes and with our lightweight design you can expect fashionable, comfortable hoops that will not pull on the ear. With the largest selection anywhere...anyone should be able to find what they need.



Posts

Additionally, we carry Huggie earrings that are hinged with curved posts and very secure. Some styles are reversible for an even greater value, as you get two looks for the price of one.

In addition to our great styles and selections for adults we carry a line of earrings specially made for children. Children's earring backs screw on and screw off and will only screw on so far to prevent embedding. Children's screw back posts are also solid and 2mm shorter than standard length for comfort in a child's ear.



Huggies

Children's

Screwbacks



READING the tag

The ability to effectively read a tag can help can help to better serve our Customers. Each tag is loaded with information that you can pass on to your Customer to provide peace of mind and confidence they are purchasing high quality jewelry.

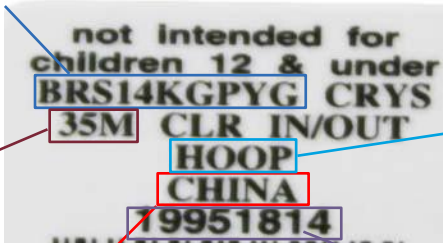
Type of Metal

Size

Style

Country of Origin

SKU number



Type of Metal

Size

Style

Country of Origin

SKU number



SKU number

Country of Origin

Type of Metal

Style

Length

Gauge



SKU number

Country of Origin

Type of Metal

Style

Length



METALS Care

Gold Care

Pure gold (24K) will not tarnish, however, all gold will darken over time. The higher the karat of gold, the less darkening will occur. Regular care and cleaning will keep your jewelry looking new indefinitely.

- Wearing jewelry while handling household cleaners such as bleach can harm your jewelry as gold can become oxidized due to bleach.
- Using hairspray, perfumes and cosmetics may also discolor your gold pieces.
- Cleaning your jewelry with Piercing Pagoda jewelry cleaner or cloth is the best method to maintain the sparkle and luster.
- Mild detergent-free, oil-free soap and water is an alternative.

Sterling Silver Care

- Sterling silver reacts with the environment.
- Sterling silver wears differently, depending on the acids in the skin and what part of the body the jewelry touches.
- Store silver jewelry in plastic bags when not being worn to slow tarnishing.
- Always recommend a Piercing Pagoda polishing cloth as the best method for cleaning.

Alternative Metal Care

- Use a Piercing Pagoda cleaning cloth to wipe stainless steel or titanium jewelry to return it to its natural luster.

TheGOLDExperience

Start a Conversation

As people walk by or approach the store, you will want to engage them in conversation. Engaging the Customer is a great start in creating an exceptional Customer Experience, as well as the first step in building trust with your Customer. When you build trust, you put the Customer at ease, and you can turn browsers into buyers.

Behaviors for Success:

- Present yourself professionally. Body language, personal appearance and a clutter-free store are all part of the Customer Experience.
- Offer a compliment to mall shoppers to capture their attention and build rapport.
- Introduce yourself and ask for the Customer's name.
- Always smile, create eye contact and begin the interaction with casual conversation starters. Here's a few examples:
 1. Are you here for an Ear Piercing today?
 2. Who are you shopping for?
 3. Did you know Piercing Pagoda is part of Signet Jewelers?
 4. Have you ever shopped with us before?
 5. Do you have your Piercing Pagoda Credit Card with you today?

Assess Wants and Needs

After you've begun to build a relationship, the next step is to get the Customer's story. What is their motivation to buy? "The Story" = details about the Recipient, Occasion and Product. Ask open-ended questions to gather as much information about the Customer's story as you can.

Don't just find out that the Customer is shopping for a birthday. Whose birthday, how old will they be and how are they celebrating? Show the Customer you care by staying engaged and maintaining eye contact. This not only continues to build rapport, but the more details you gather in this step, the more information you have for your presentation.

Here, you will also want to find out if the Customer has a Piercing Pagoda Credit Card!

Behaviors for Success:

- Tell me about your style.
- How will you be wearing the item? Special occasion or every day?
- What's the occasion? How are you celebrating?
- Tell me about the person you are shopping for, what's their style?
- What were you thinking about getting? Do you have a picture?
- When was the last time you shopped with us? Do you have a Piercing Pagoda Credit Card?

Lead Through the Presentation

Now that you have your Customer's story, tie product features to benefits with check questions while recommending additional items, and an Extended Service Agreement (ESA).

Tip: Use the Customer's words in your presentation! Ex: If the Customer said they were looking for something "delicate," make sure you use the word "delicate" in your check questions.

Behaviors for Success:

- Remove the product from the case and read the tag.
- Show a variety of styles while utilizing feature, benefit, check to help them find the perfect item (see pg 9).
 - A feature speaks to attributes of a product such as the metal, craftsmanship or diamond quality.
- Present a minimum of 2 pieces of jewelry on a presentation pad.
- Offer additional add-on items to the Customer using the Customer's story.
- Explain the ESA service with features and benefits using the Customer's story.
- Offer the Piercing Pagoda Credit Card in a way that is relevant to the Customer by listening to credit cues.

The **GOLD** Experience



Scenario: A Customer tells you they are looking for a new chain because they have trouble with small clasps but enjoy wearing a necklace daily.

Feature

This solid 22 inch 10k gold rope chain features a lobster clasp.

Benefit

This item is very durable, can be worn every day and you won't have any trouble with the clasp.

Check

Won't it be great to have a chain you can put on yourself every day?

Eliminate Objections

Once you have built trust, gathered the Customer's story, and connected the features to the benefits, sometimes the Customer will hesitate or object. Your goal during this step is to identify the concern, and acknowledge and empathize with the Customer's concern. Then, offer a solution.

Behaviors for Success:

- Listen to the Customer's concerns, be empathetic not argumentative.
- Restate and reassure the Customer how the items meet the needs identified in their story.
- Use Feature/Benefit/Check Questions to overcome objections.
- Overcome budget objections using low payment options with a Piercing Pagoda Credit Card or layaway.
- Reinforce the Pagoda legacy and Signet affiliation.
- Reassure the Customer of ESA benefits.

Secure the Sale

Complete a fantastic Customer Experience and get the Customer to commit to their purchase by asking for the sale using closing phrases.

Behaviors for Success:

- Offer to box the Customer's selection.
- Reinforce financing options and benefits of the Piercing Pagoda Credit Card.
- Thank the Customer by name.
- Present a business card.
- Ask for Piercing Customer referrals.

Closing Phrases:

- Are we putting this on your Piercing Pagoda Credit Card today?
- May I box this up for you?
- Would you like to get the matching piece with this item?